

Funding innovation

A report on the impact of equity and grant finance



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“ Equity and grant-backed companies do better because they have more money, and **grants help de-risk equity**. But grants can distract companies as they'll just seek more for the sake of it, and not use it properly. That skews their focus because **grant and market demands often conflict**.

Martyn Buxton-Hoare,
Director of Technology Transfer

Founded 1891

Innovate UK projects 56

Innovate UK funding £8.47m

Number of students 15,050, over three faculties — Arts and Social Sciences, Engineering and Physical Sciences, Health and Medical Sciences.



Invests between \$500k - \$15m

Transactions funded
Growth capital, MBOs and acquisitions.

Investment focus Technology, with a focus on electronics, software, internet, medtech, and mobile.

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“ Frequently companies will get grants before equity, so **grants are a useful signal of the technology moving into the market**.

Because the grant-winning process is difficult, it says something about the entrepreneur. But for the most part the grant sums on offer are small compared to VC rounds.

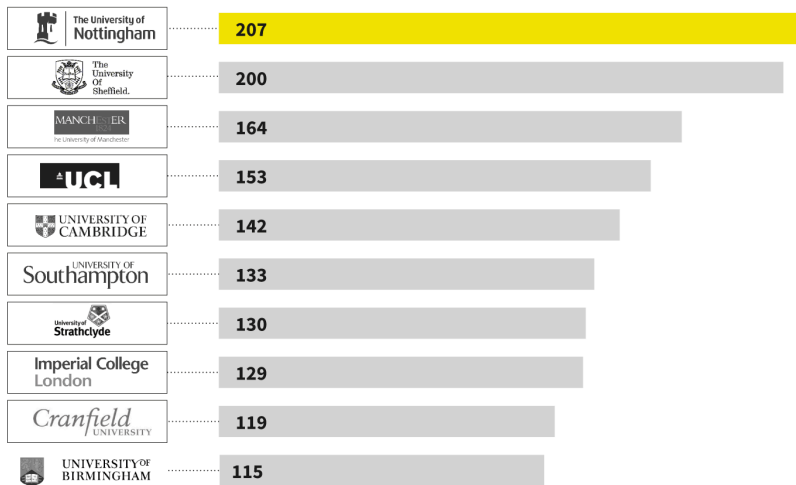
David Cummings, Partner
Isabella Cookson, Head of Research

University ranking
Universities are ranked by both number of IUK-funded projects and total IUK grant funding.

Equity investment
When used together with grant funding, equity investment has significant effects on company valuations.

Regional distribution
Both equity and grant finance are regionally concentrated. We look at every region in the UK.

Universities ranked by number of projects



Size of equity investments



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Distribution of equity and grant funding by region



The key findings from this report

Grants into the Russell Group

Micro projects funded

Grants into pharmaceuticals

£604m

Average pre-money without grants

£6.4m

7235

Grant funding into North East

3.1%

6%

Average grant with equity

£494m

About the authors



BEN MCLEOD

Ben is a specialist in business finance and grant funding. He is a key member of Beauhurst's business development team, building long-term relationships with tech transfer and commercialisation arms of universities, venture capital firms, government and financial services businesses.

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ELLA HALMARI

Ella is a visual design and data analysis specialist. She is an expert in data visualisation and content creation, playing a lead role in analysis and production of Beauhurst's data-driven publications and brand communications. Ella holds a post-graduate diploma in Visual Communication from UAL and the IMC qualification from the CFA Society.

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